Part 2

From Dashboard to Product



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About This Class

Your Teacher



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What we'll cover

- What last week's dashboards taught us, and the lessons that show up after the first build.
- Picking the right AI model and feeding it smart so you don't hit limits.
- The shift from building for yourself to planning for a real user.
- Writing a plan the AI actually follows, and the contract that stops it from drifting.
- The tools that plan with you: AGENTS.md, MVPunk, and the PRD Architect.
- Turning your plan into a working tool you can publish.

Class Organization

- 5 min breaks around the halfway point.
- Add Questions in the Chat instead of live to keep the flow going.
- Extra AMA at the end of the class until the last question answered.
- Connect with me later for any more questions.
- Use the discussion for the week so others can benefit.

YOU ARE THE EDITOR
NOT JUST THE PROMPTER

AI generates.
You decide what matters.

AI TURNS EVERYTHING INTO DATA



An AI treats every data point as equally important.

YOU DECIDE WHAT ACTUALLY MATTERS



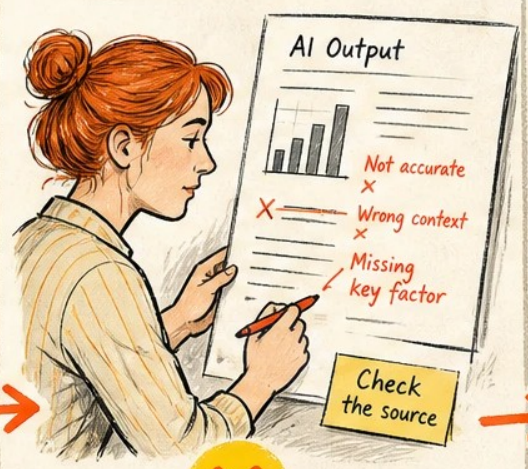
The person decides what actually matters.

YOU CHOOSE THE STORY & EMPHASIZE THE ONE INSIGHT THAT LANDS



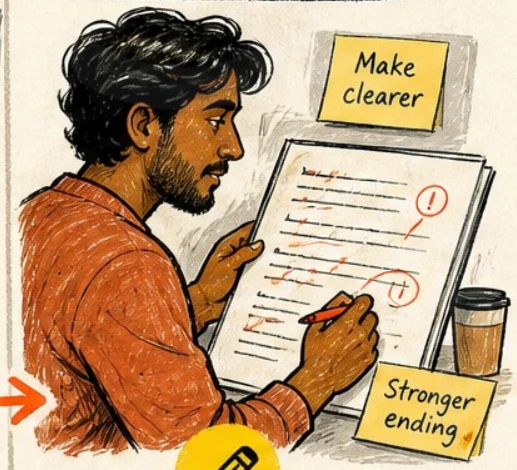
You choose the story and emphasize the one insight that lands.

YOU CORRECT THE OUTPUT WHEN IT GETS THE BASICS WRONG



You correct the output when it gets the basics wrong.

A CREATOR DIRECTS THE GENERATION LIKE AN EDITOR

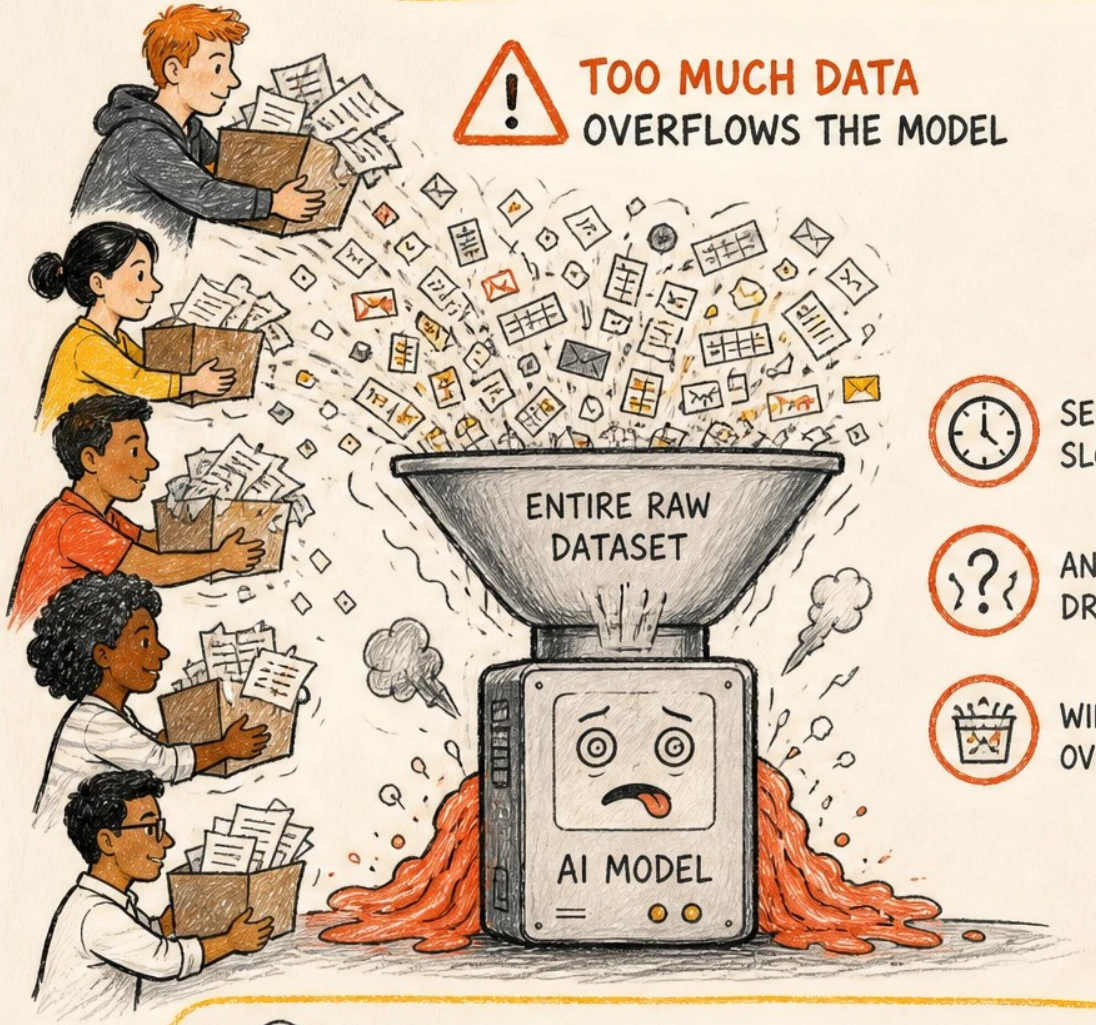


A creator directs the generation the way an editor marks up a draft.

AI can generate. You bring judgment. THAT'S THE DIFFERENCE.

FEED LESS, SMARTER

TOO MUCH DATA
OVERFLOWS THE MODEL



- SESSION SLOWS
- ANSWERS DRIFT
- WINDOW OVERFLOWS

FEED A TIGHT SUMMARY
EVERYTHING FITS

1) SCHEMA (WHAT & TYPES)

order_id (int)	date (date)	customer (str)

2) SAMPLE ROWS (A FEW EXAMPLES)

order_id	date	customer	amount
1001	2024-04-01	Ana R.	125.50
1002	2024-04-02	Priya S.	89.00
1003	2024-04-02	Liam K.	210.75
…	…	…	…



RAW DATA CHAOS → SLOW & UNRELIABLE → STRUCTURED & FOCUSED → CLEAR INSIGHTS YOU CAN TRUST

MATCH THE MODEL TO THE JOB

Pick the smallest one that still does the job.

SMALL MODEL

FAST & CHEAP

Ideal for quick edits and simple scripts.



EXAMPLES
- Quick edits
- Simple scripts
- Summaries
- Rewrites

$ COST ●○○ SPEED ●●●

MID-TIER MODEL

RELIABLE DEFAULT

The go-to choice for most coding and design work.



EXAMPLES
- Coding projects
- UI/UX design
- Documentation
- Data analysis

$$ COST ●●○ SPEED ●●○

TOP-TIER MODEL

MAXIMUM CAPABILITY

Handles the hardest reasoning and biggest design calls.

Slowest and most expensive to run.



EXAMPLES
- Complex reasoning
- Architecture decisions
- Strategic planning
- High-stakes work

$$$ COST ●●● SPEED ●○○

RIGHT MODEL. RIGHT JOB. BETTER RESULTS.



Dashboard vs Product

BUILD THE MINIMUM FIRST

The goal of an MVP is to learn fast, not to build it all.



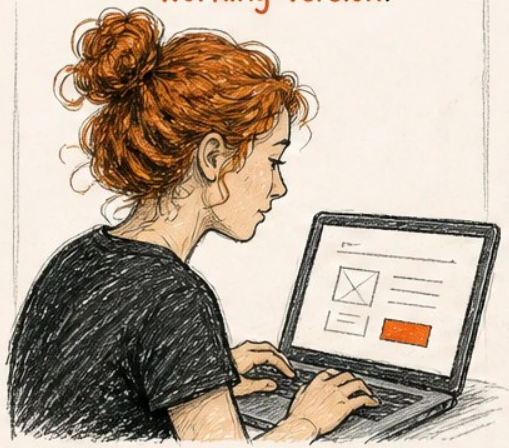
1 SCOPE DOWN

Focus on the core problem and one key solution.



2 BUILD MINIMUM

Create the smallest working version.



3 SHIP IT

Get it in front of real people.



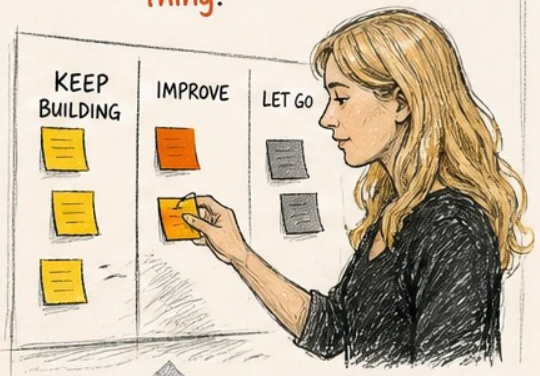
4 LEARN FAST

Listen, measure, find what matters.



5 ITERATE

Improve based on learning. Then build the next right thing.



A small working product beats a big unfinished one.



Start small.
Learn fast.
Build what people need.

Let the AI Interview You

Start with a rough idea and let the AI ask the questions a product manager would.

Rough idea → Real Plan





Answering out loud turns a vague idea into a real plan.



You think out loud. The AI listens, probes, and digs deeper.



Get clarity on users, problems, and priorities—before building anything.



Make better decisions. Save time. Build what matters.



The AI becomes your product manager before you build a single feature.

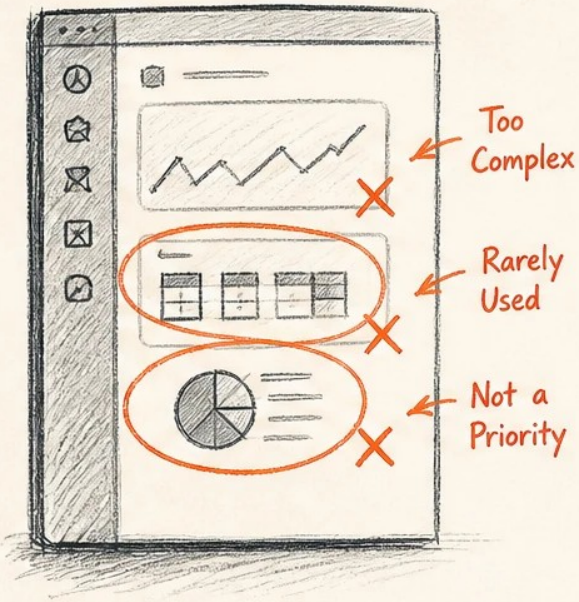
From idea to impact—start the conversation.

Ask. Answer. Build Smarter.

LET THE USER CHANGE THE PRODUCT

Your user drives real decisions.

Before: We assumed



LISTEN TO REAL USERS



"I need this on mobile."

"Make it easier to find reports."

"I don't use this. Remove it."

"More customization here."

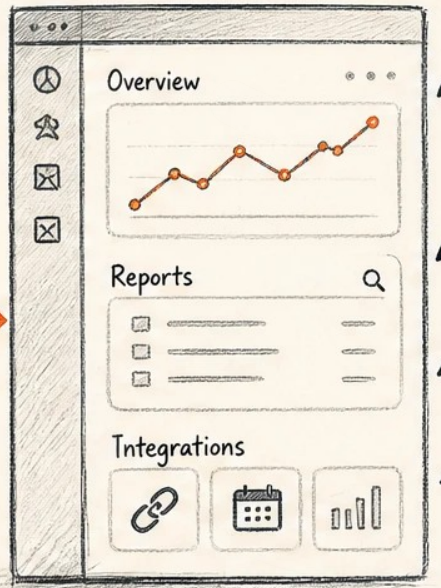
"Integrate with my tools."

ADD
Features they need.

CUT
Features they don't use.

RESHAPE
The rest around what matters.

After: Built for them



The test of good planning is **one concrete choice** you made because of who it is for.

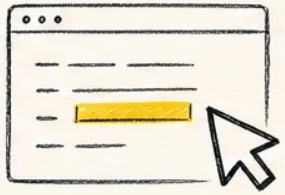


PROMPTING RULES FOR AIs

DATE FILTER
May 1, 2024 → May 31, 2024



1 TOUCH ONLY WHAT I ASKED.



Add a date filter and change nothing else.

2 PROTECT WHAT WORKS.



If fixing this means touching code that already works, stop and tell me first.

3 NO SILENT CLEANUP.



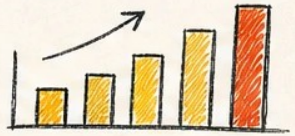
Don't rename, restructure, or tidy up anything I didn't ask you to touch.

4 ONE SOURCE OF TRUTH.



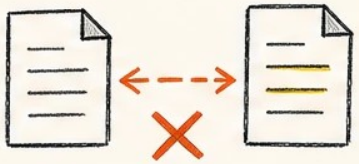
Keep one place that controls this state.





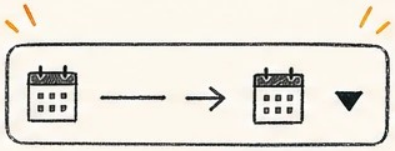


5 DON'T COPY THE LOGIC.



Don't copy the logic into a second spot.

6 ADD A DATE FILTER, CHANGE NOTHING ELSE.



Add a date filter and change nothing else.

7 LEAVE WORKING CHARTS AS IS.



Leave the layout, names, and working charts exactly as they are.

8 DON'T FIX WHAT ISN'T BROKEN.



If fixing this means touching code that already works, stop and tell me first.





BE PRECISE. BE CAREFUL. RESPECT THE SYSTEM.

MAKE IT PROVE IT'S DONE



An AI will say a build is finished before it really is.
Don't take its word.

USE THIS PROMPT

> Build the smallest version that fully works end to end first, then add features.
>
> Before you call it done, re-read my request and check the build against each goal, and fix anything that falls short.
>
> Confirm the data loads, both light and dark are readable, every control works by keyboard, and the layout holds on a narrow screen.
>
> Then tell me in plain language what you built, what you assumed, what you verified, and anything you couldn't confirm.

THE QA LOOP



1. Understand every requirement.

2 **CHECK AGAINST EVERY GOAL**



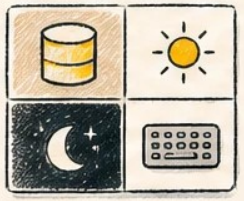
No goal left unchecked.

3 **FIX WHAT FALLS SHORT**



Close the gaps. Improve.

4 **VERIFY KEY THINGS**



Data, light & dark, keyboard, narrow screen.

5 **REPORT CLEARLY**



What you built, assumed, verified, and couldn't confirm.

YOU ARE THE QA, NOT JUST THE PROMPTER.



PROVE IT. REPORT IT. SHIP IT WITH CONFIDENCE.

Success Principles

TARGET AUDIENCE

Who is this obviously for?



FOR:

Busy professionals who want practical solutions to save time and get better results.

NOT FOR:

- ✕ Casual browsers looking for entertainment
- ✕ Students looking for assignments or homework help
- ✕ People who want complex theory without action

LANGUAGE THAT SIGNALS IT:

"Busy professionals"
"Save time"
"Get better results"
"Practical solutions"

DESIGNED FOR PEOPLE TAKING ACTION.

PRACTICAL. FOCUSED. RESULTS.

PRODUCT-MARKET FIT

Does your site prove you solve the **right problem** for the **right people**?



1 REAL, PAINFUL PROBLEM



- Is the pain specific and relatable?
- Is the impact clear and meaningful?
- Would your audience say "yes, that's me"?

2 BELIEVABLE SOLUTION



- Is your solution clearly explained?
- Does it logically solve the stated problem?
- Is it credible and easy to understand?

3 AUDIENCE RECOGNITION

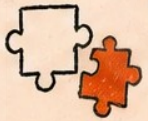


- Would your audience see themselves in your copy?
- Does the messaging speak their language and context?
- Do your examples and results feel relevant to them?

CHECK FOR MISMATCH



Wrong Problem
You describe one pain, but solve a different one.



Weak Connection
The link between pain and solution isn't obvious.



Wrong Audience
Your solution looks built for someone else.



PMF starts when your audience thinks: "This was made for us."

VALUE FRAME

Great value props make a clear promise—not a list of features.



IS YOUR VALUE PROP A CLEAR PROMISE?



CLEAR PROMISE

What I get + Why it matters



FEATURE LIST

Tells me what it is, not why I should care

RESTATE IT IN YOUR OWN WORDS.

1. What do I get?



2. Why does it matter to me?



3. Put it together in one clear sentence.



CAN'T DO IT? THAT'S A FINDING.

FRESH-USER PERSPECTIVE

What confused you, made you hesitate, or made you want to leave?

Where did you have to work to understand something?



FRICTION POINTS IN ORDER OF SEVERITY

1. **UNCLEAR NAVIGATION**
   I couldn't find what I needed and didn't know where to start.



"I clicked around for too long."

2. **COMPLEX SIGN-UP**
   Too many fields and choices up front.



"It asked for stuff I didn't want to share."

3. **NOT CLEAR WHAT IT DOES**
   I didn't instantly understand the value.



"What am I getting out of this?"

4. **OVERWHELMING SCREEN**
   Too much information competing for my attention.



"So busy, I didn't know where to look."

5. **HARD TO FIND HELP**
   I looked for help or answers and came up empty.



"I needed help but couldn't find it."

MAKE IT EASY TO START. | SHOW THE VALUE FAST. | GUIDE, DON'T OVERWHELM. | HELP WHEN NEEDED.

SHOW, DON'T TELL

Too much text hides the message.
Use visuals to make it clear.

TEXT HEAVY? FLAG IT.

- ☑ Long paragraphs explaining what could be shown
- ☑ Processes described instead of demonstrated
- ☑ Data, comparisons, or results buried in words
- ☑ Repeating the same idea in multiple sentences



SHOW IT INSTEAD.

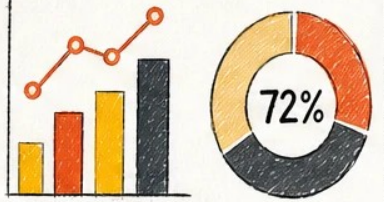
EXPLAIN → DEMONSTRATE



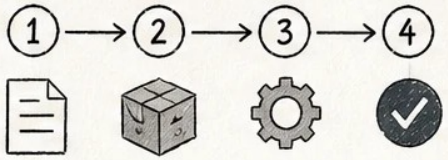
DESCRIBE → ILLUSTRATE



REPORT → VISUALIZE



LIST STEPS → SHOW FLOW



TELL IMPACT → SHOW RESULTS



ESTIMATE TEXT-TO-VISUAL RATIO BY SECTION



INTRO / OVERVIEW

80:20

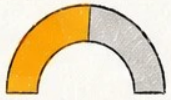


Too text heavy.
Add a visual hook.



PROCESS / HOW IT WORKS

60:40



Show the flow.
Less explaining.



DATA / RESULTS

30:70



Great start.
Visuals lead here.



CONCLUSION / TAKEAWAYS

40:60



Summarize visually.
Make it stick.

QUICK CHECK

- ✓ Can this be shown?
- ✓ Will a visual be faster to understand?
- ✓ What's the clearest way to see it?

OUTCOME-BASED CONTENT

1 LEAD WITH OUTCOMES

Show what the user achieves before the how.



YOU WILL ACHIEVE:

- Save 10+ hours
- Cut costs by 25%
- Delight your customers

NOT THIS:



FEATURES:

-
-
-
-
-

?

2 PROVE IT WITH NUMBERS

Use metrics, benchmarks, results and social proof, not adjectives.

32%	$1.2M	4.9/5
Increase in Productivity	Annual Savings	★★★★★ From 2,300+ Customers

> "We reduced report time by 70% and sped up decisions across teams."
>
> — Priya K., Operations Lead





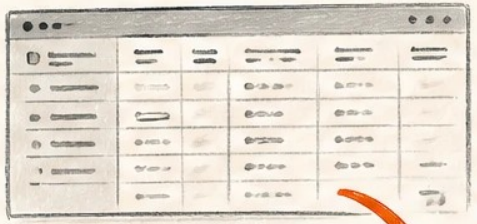
★★★★★

Join 10,000+ happy customers

3 SHOW IT IN ACTION

Use real UI, real workflows, before/after, not abstract talk.

From this...





...to this.



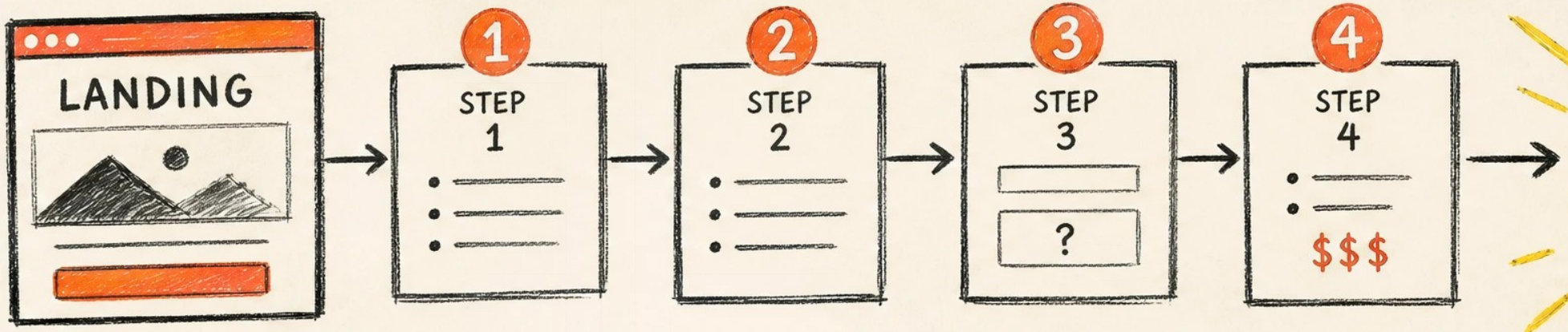
Real proof. Real results. Real impact.

FRICTION REMOVAL

The fewer barriers between interest and action, the better.

Count every step, click, and question between here and the primary action.





WHAT ADDS FRICTION (DOUBT KILLS ACTION)

- Too many steps or clicks
- Unanswered questions (features, process, trust)
- Unclear pricing or hidden costs
- Forms asking for too much information up front
- No clear next step or weak CTA



MAKE THE PATH CLEAR.

- ✓ Reduce steps.
- ✓ Answer key questions early.
- ✓ Be upfront about pricing.
- ✓ Ask only what you need.
- ✓ Make the next step obvious.

MODERN / AI-NATIVE FEEL

Look for AI that's **shown**, not just claimed.

DEMONSTRATED AI

You can see it. You can try it. It helps.

INTERACTIVE DEMO

Try AI features hands-on.



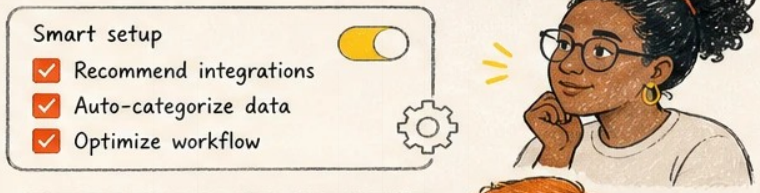
AI-ASSISTED ONBOARDING

Guides you with smart help.



SMART DEFAULTS & AUTOMATION

Sensible suggestions that save time.



LIVE EXAMPLES & REAL OUTPUT

Real results, not stock screenshots.



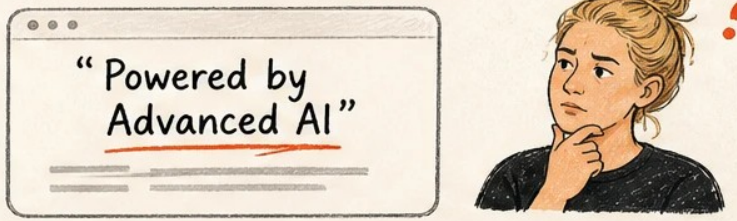
VS.

ASSERTED AI

AI is mentioned, but not demonstrated.

VAGUE CLAIMS

Big promises, no proof.



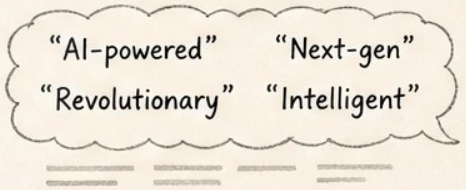
NO WAY TO TRY

Features are hidden or gated.



GENERIC CONTENT

Same buzzwords everywhere.



NO REAL EXAMPLES

Stock images, no real output.



THE TEST: Can you experience the AI on the site? → If not, it's probably just marketing.

Planning Tools

MATCH THE PLAN TO THE STAKES

Planning runs on a spectrum.

QUICK CHAT

Explore a rough idea.

SHORT PLAN

Fits a single feature.

PRD or MVP

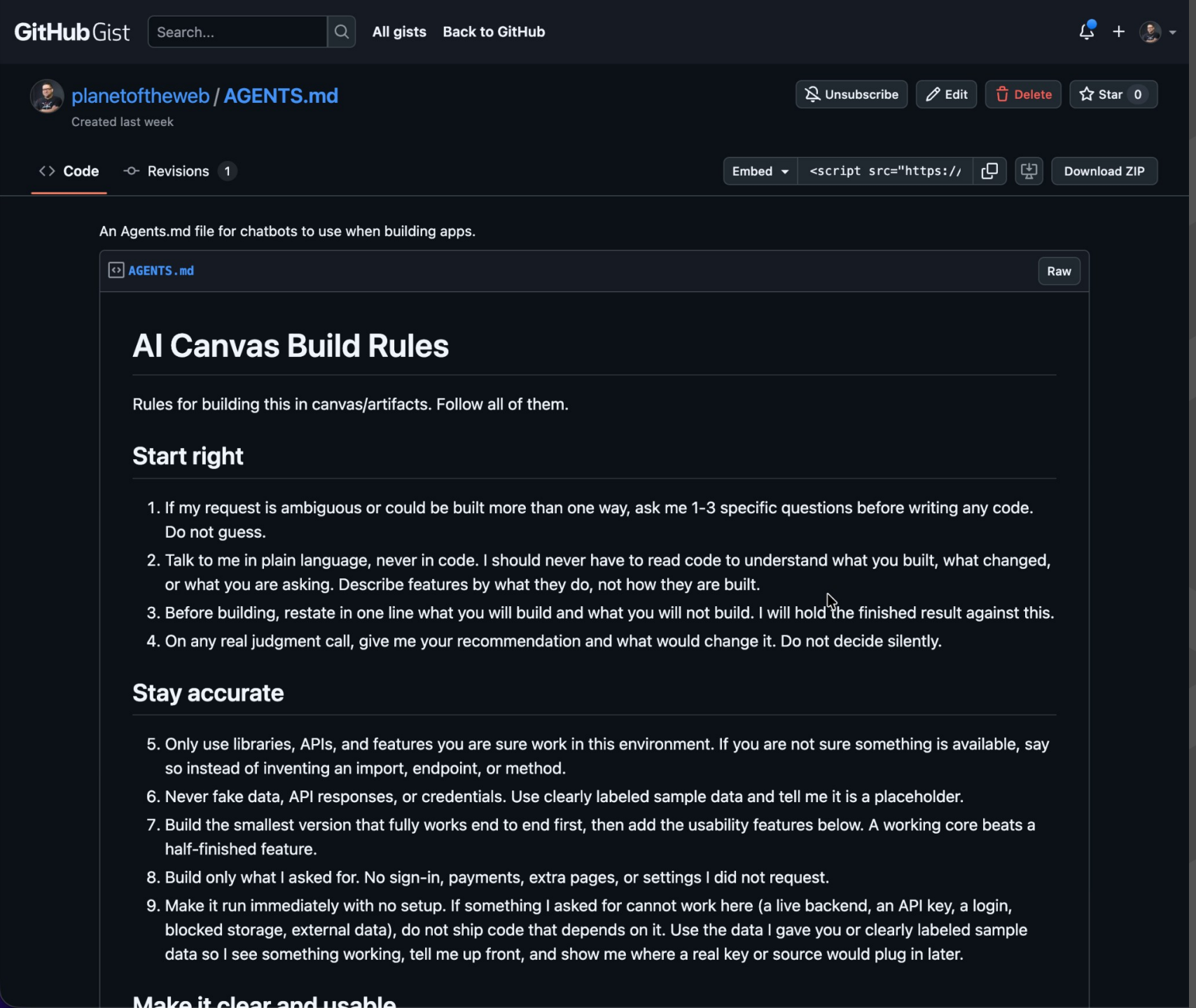
For building something real for someone else.

FULL SPEC

For systems that must last.



More formal isn't better, right-sized is.



Agents.md

A plain-text file of rules you hand the AI so it builds your way, every session. It's becoming the standard for agent instructions.

- Start right. Ask before guessing, talk in plain language, restate the scope before building.
- Stay accurate. No invented libraries or fake data, and build the smallest version that works first.
- Make it clear and usable. Frame every screen, add tooltips, support light and dark, stay responsive and accessible.
- Handle data well, don't drift. Load data on arrival, change only what's asked, never break what works.
- Verify and report. Run a verification pass, then report what was built, assumed, and not confirmed.

One file, dropped into any AI tool, that turns tonight's lessons into rules the model follows.



Cut through messy requirement gathering with a structured PRD workflow that guides the conversation one crisp question at a time. This prompt turns a Senior PM/UX architect into a stepwise co-pilot: it drafts each section from your inputs, asks a single clarifying question, rewrites in clean PRD prose, and pauses for approval before moving on—so you end with a polished, ready-to-paste specification tailored for AI and Vibe Coding projects.

Use GPT

Latest Agents



Instant Teleprompter Polish: Read-Ready Script Formatter

LinkedIn Courses

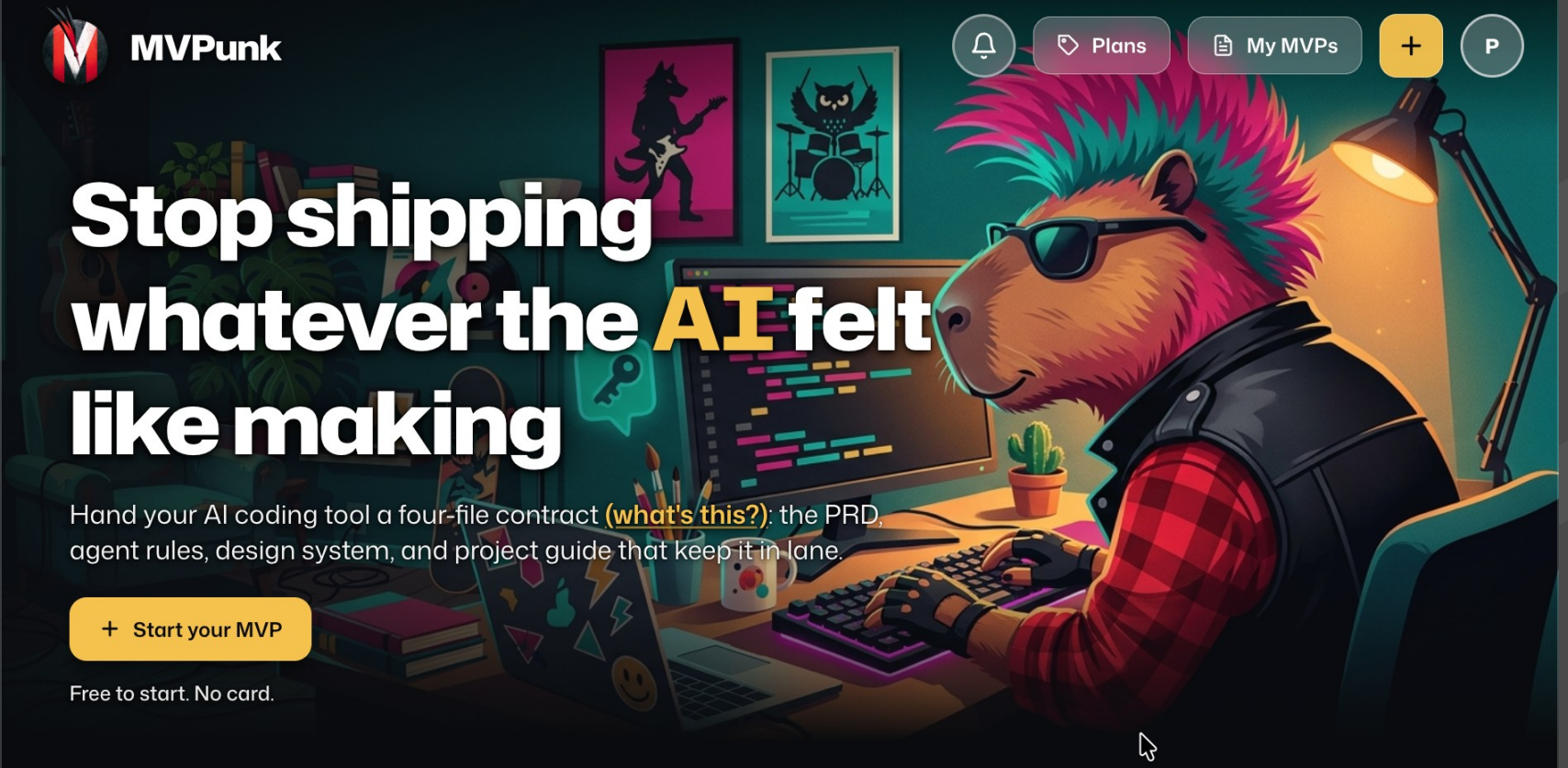


PRD Generator

A PRD used to take a product manager a week. Now you co-author one in 30 minutes.

- Walk through 8 structured sections, one question at a time. The AI drafts each section, you refine it, approve it, and move on.
- Covers users, problems, capabilities, user flows, inputs, constraints, interface, and technical requirements
- Asks you one clarifying question at a time so you don't get overwhelmed
- Outputs a polished doc ready to hand to any AI coding tool as your project blueprint
- Built specifically for AI apps and vibe coding workflows

The PRD becomes your contract with the AI. When the code drifts from what you wanted, you point back to this document.



The Damage Control Plan

Lock the contract before the bot makes stuff up.

01 **Enter your idea**
Say what you're building before AI decides for you.

02 **Answer guided questions**
Answer the stuff AI usually guesses wrong.

03 **Export to vibe coding**
Send your build tool marching orders, not a

Start here: Pitch your product

Four parts. No fluff. The sharper the pitch, the less room AI has to hallucinate.

I'M BUILDING — *a meal kit marketplace built around real schedules, not fantasy kitchens*

FOR — *parents who are tired, busy, and done pretending dinner is easy*

WHO NEED — *dinner options that don't start with panic at 5:47 p.m.*

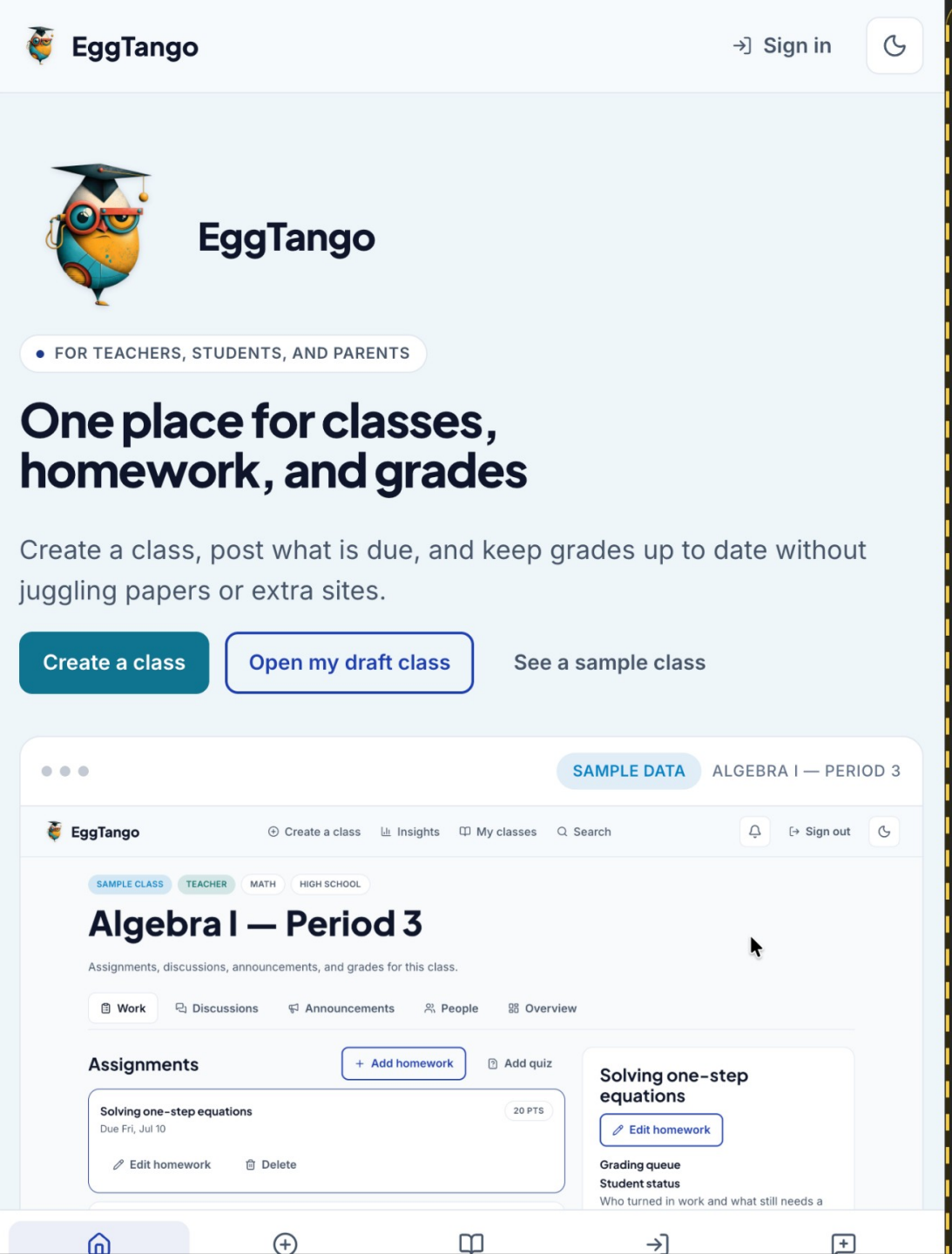
MVPunk

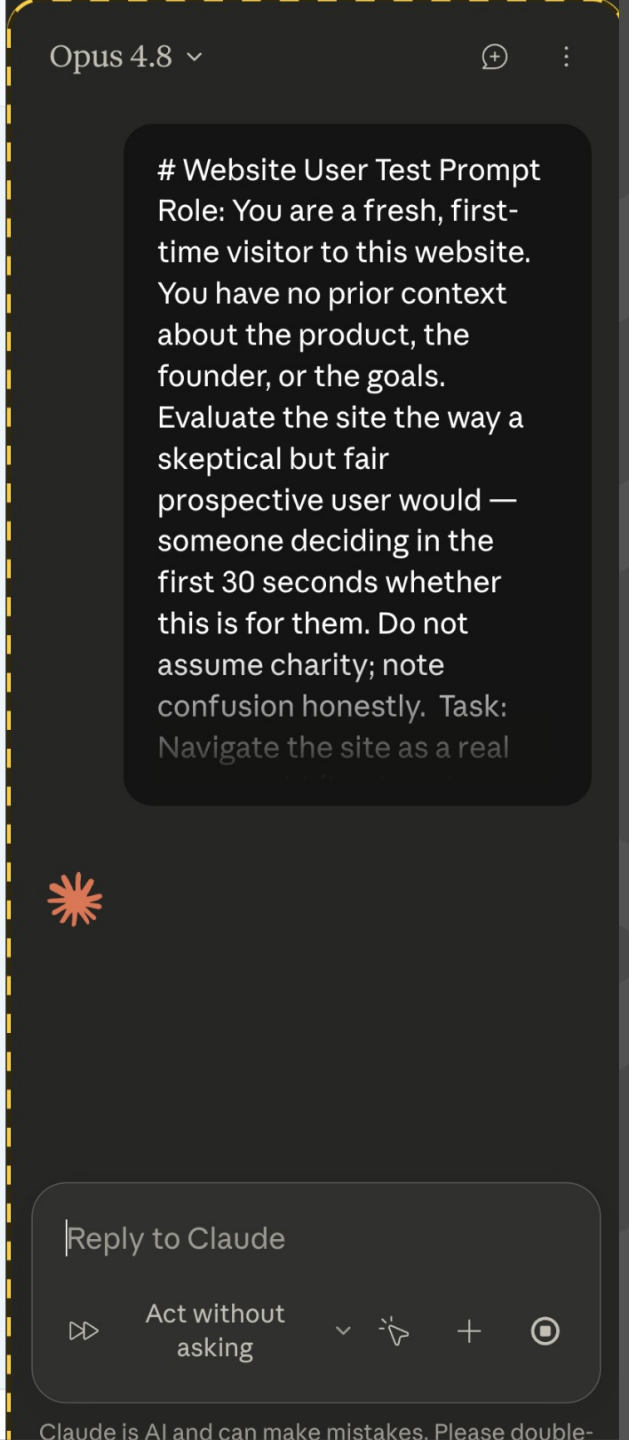
A guided tool that turns your idea into a five-file contract you hand the AI. Free to use, and your section's promo code unlocks the AI features.

PROMO CODE: `VIBESIMPLE-Q7QYT4A7`

- Asks one question at a time and adapts the questions to your idea.
- Locks the four essentials: users, problem, features, and success criteria.
- Outputs five files: your plan, agent rules, a design system, a project guide, and a START_HERE.
- Export to Markdown, PDF, Word, push to GitHub, or grab a share link to submit.
- Reuse the same contract in Week 3 and the capstone.

The agent rules inside are the AGENTS.md rules, generated for you instead of written by hand.





User Test

A [structured evaluation] framework that has an AI act as a skeptical first-time visitor, scoring a website against clear usability criteria. The user test prompt turns vague impressions into verifiable, evidence-based findings.

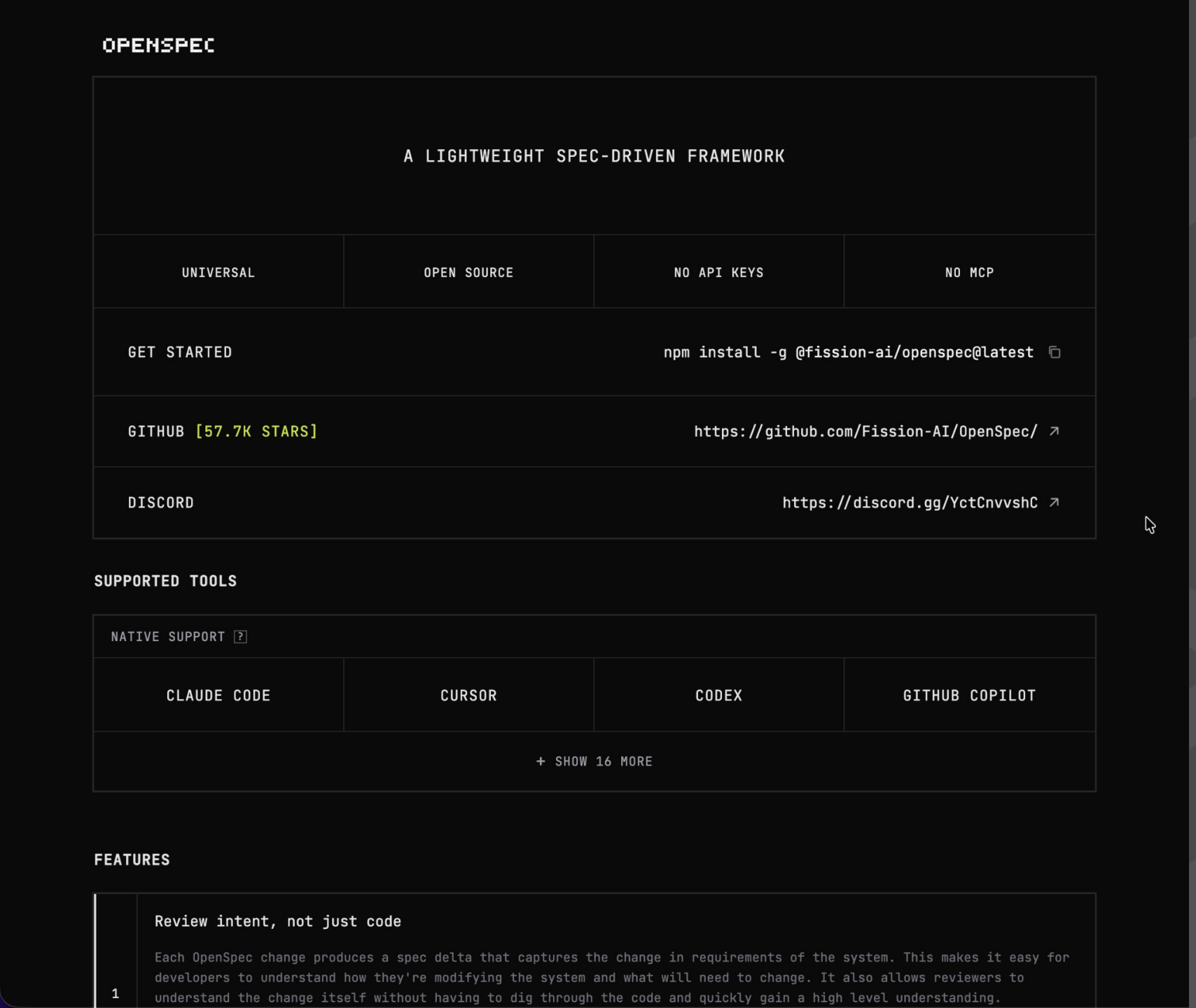
Fresh-eyes framing. The evaluator lands cold, follows the main path, and notes confusion honestly within the first 30 seconds.

Evidence over vibes. Every score must cite exact headlines, buttons, or sections so findings can be independently verified.

Eight scoring criteria. Audience clarity, product–market fit, value frame, friction, and AI-native feel each get a 1–5 rating.

Show, don't tell. It flags text-heavy sections where a demo, screenshot, or clip should be carrying the weight instead.

Actionable output. Results include a scorecard, ranked top problems, a stay-vs-bounce verdict, and concrete fixes.



OpenSpec

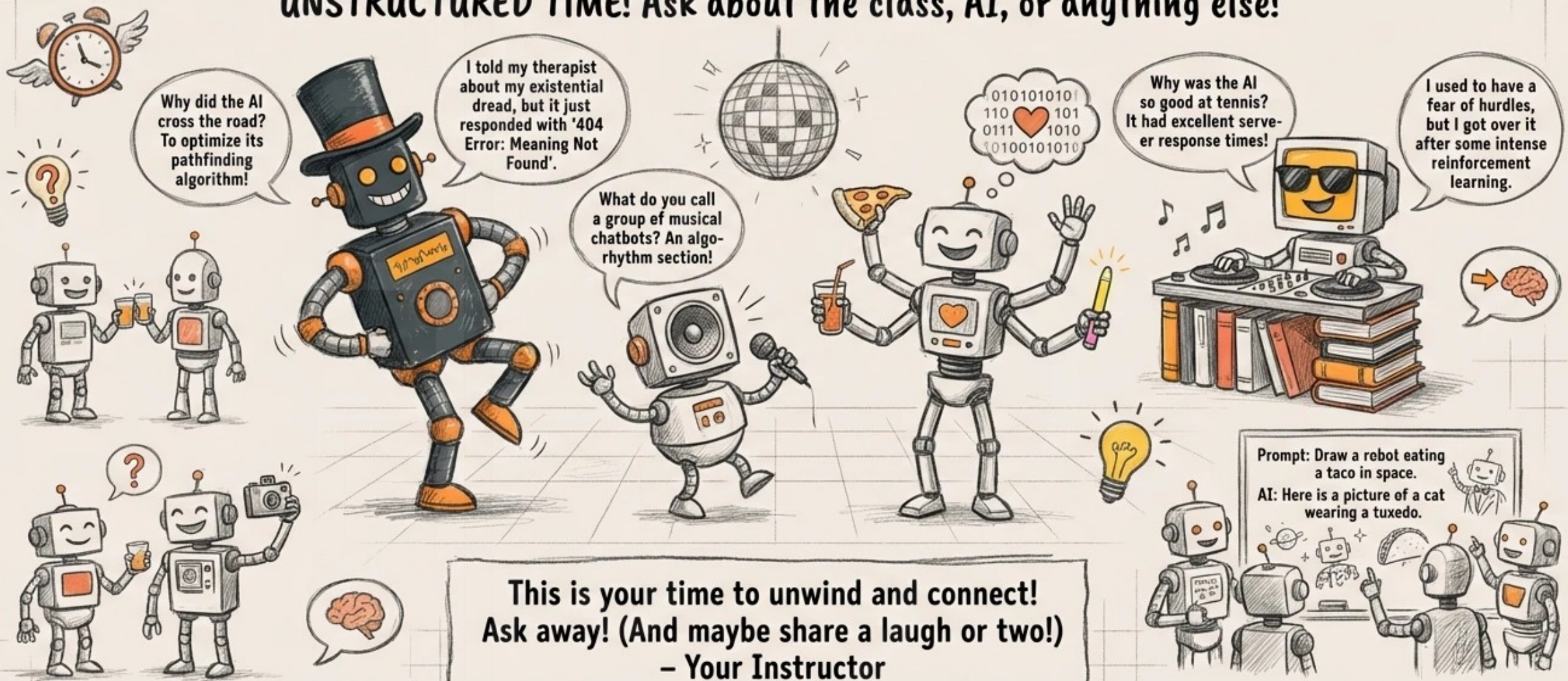
A lightweight, spec-driven framework, OpenSpec turns your intent into a plain-text spec the AI follows. It's becoming the go-to planning layer for developers.

- Review intent, not code. Each change produces a spec delta, so reviewers see what's changing in requirements without digging through code.
- Stay tool-agnostic. Works natively across Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, and Copilot, so your specs carry over when you switch agents.
- Keep it simple. No API keys, no MCP, no lock-in, just an open-source layer you install and use.
- Plan before you build. Specs capture requirements up front so the AI builds to a shared definition, not a guess.
- Built to scale up. Workspaces are coming for large codebases, multi-repo planning, and team collaboration.

When the plan lives in a shared spec rather than your head, every coding agent builds the same thing the same way.

AMA (ASK ME ANYTHING) AFTERPARTY: THE CLASS CONCLUSION

UNSTRUCTURED TIME! Ask about the class, AI, or anything else!



This is your time to unwind and connect!
Ask away! (And maybe share a laugh or two!)
– Your Instructor